PART II—AWARD INFORMATION

This document describes general characteristics of all grant types available across the AFRI portfolio, as well as applicant eligibility for those grant and project types. Applicants should also review the AFRI Part IV, C, on the AFRI Notice of Funding Opportunities Resources page, for Foundational & Applied Science (FAS), Education & Workforce Development (EWD), and Strengthening Agricultural System (SAS) for further application content and formatting guidance.

C. Project Types and Grant Types

2. Grant Types

Applicants must select the appropriate AFRI grant type specified within the relevant Program Area Priority Description in **Part I, C** of the NOFO. Only grant types specifically solicited under each program area or program area priority described in **Part I, C** of the NOFO will be considered for review.

There are five main categories of grant types available across the Agriculture and Food Research Initiative (AFRI). They are described below. One of these categories is the suite of Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement (FASE) Grants, which have specific eligibility restrictions, as described in section 4 below. FASE Grants include three distinct types of grants: a) Pre- and Postdoctoral Fellowships Grants; b) New Investigator Grants; and c) Strengthening Grants, each of which have specific eligibility restrictions that are described subsequently.

Not all grant types are solicited within each Notice of Funding Opportunity (NOFO) or by each Program Area Priority within each NOFO. Applicants should refer to the specific Program Area Priority description of interest for the grant types solicited by that Program Area Priority.

1. **Standard Grants**
   Standard Grants support original scientific Research, Education, Extension, or Integrated Projects.

   The Foundational & Applied Science project narrative page limit for Standard Grant applications is 18 pages unless specified otherwise in the NOFO or the AFRI NOFO Additional Information for Part IV, C (e.g., Rapid Response to Weather Events Across Food and Agricultural Systems A1712 and Rapid Response to Emerging and Re-emerging Pest and Disease Events Across Food and Agricultural Systems A1713)

   The Education and Workforce Development project narrative page limit is 10 pages for all programs, except for the Predoctoral Fellowship program which has a 6-page limit.

2. **Coordinated Agricultural Project (CAP) Grant**
   Coordinated Agricultural Project (CAP) Grant is a type of Research, Education, Extension, or Integrated Project that supports large-scale, multi-million dollar projects to promote collaboration, open communication, and the exchange of information; reduce duplication of effort; and coordinate activities among individuals, institutions, States, and regions. Integrated CAP Grants address problems through multi-function projects that incorporate at least two of the three components of the agricultural knowledge system (*i.e.*, research, extension, and education), although some program areas may require that CAP Grant applications include all three components of the agricultural knowledge system. In a CAP Grant, participants serve as a team that conducts targeted research, education, and/or extension in response to emerging or priority area(s) of national need. Applications articulate how a CAP Grant will complement and/or link with existing programs or projects at the national level. A CAP Grant contains the needed science-based expertise in research, education, and/or extension, as well as expertise from principal stakeholders and partners, to accomplish project goals and objectives. Applications should outline the potential of the project, the structure, coordination, and plan of implementation, and propose several research, education, and/or extension areas that will be evaluated during the study period. All Research, Education, Extension, and Integrated Project requirements described under Project Types (See AFRI Notice of Funding Opportunity) apply to CAP Grants.

   Project Narrative page limit for all CAP Grant applications is 18 pages.

3. **Workshop Grants**
   Workshop Grants support highly interactive gatherings that bring together scientists to identify research, education, and/or extension needs, update information, or advance an area of science. These activities are recognized as integral parts of scientific efforts. Support for a limited number of workshops covering subject matter encompassed by the FAS or EWD solicitation will be considered for partial or, if modest, total support. NIFA will not support Workshop Grants with the sole purpose of supporting travel or to be implemented as subawards for travel grants. Individual Workshop Grants may not exceed $50,000 in total costs and are not renewable. Indirect costs are not permitted on Workshop Grant awards. For all requests of $25,000 or more, applicants should consult with the program contact listed in the notice of funding opportunity (NOFO) regarding suitability of the application for submission to the relevant program area priority.

   If Workshop Grants are among the grant types solicited by a Program Area Priority, then the Workshop Grant application may encompass any project type (i.e., research, education, extension or integrated), regardless of the project type solicited by that specific Program Area Priority. The workshop must, however, cover the subject matter encompassed by the specific Program Area Priority of interest, as indicated above.

The workshop grant LOI must be submitted to the program area priority contact(s) a minimum of 195 days before the workshop begins for Foundational and Applied Science Program Workshop Grants and a minimum of 255 days before the workshop begins for Education and Workforce Development Program Workshop Grants. Applications should be submitted after receiving an LOI decision response and must be submitted a minimum of 150 days before the workshop begins for Foundational and Applied Science Program Workshop Grants and a minimum of 210 days before the workshop begins for Education and Workforce Development Program Workshop Grants.

Project Narrative page limit for all Workshop Grant applications is 18 pages.

4. Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement Grants

Food and Agricultural Science Enhancement (FASE) Grants strengthen science capabilities in research, education, and/or extension programs. FASE Grants are designed to help institutions develop competitive projects, and to attract new scientists and educators into careers in high-priority areas of national need in agriculture and food sciences. FASE Grants provide support for Pre- and Postdoctoral Fellowships, New Investigators, and Strengthening Grants. Specific eligibility requirements for these grants are described below.

a. Pre- and Postdoctoral Fellowships Grants

Pre- and Postdoctoral Fellowships Grants provide fellowships to doctoral candidates and students who recently completed their doctoral degree in the agricultural sciences. The program goals are to prepare the next generation of scientists through doctoral and postdoctoral fellowships.

Project Narrative page limit for Predoctoral Fellowship Grant applications is 6 pages and for Postdoctoral Fellowship Grant applications is 10 pages.

b. New Investigator Grants

New Investigator Grant opportunities are intended to support early career scientists. An individual who has obtained a PhD or terminal degree in their field and is beginning their career, does not have an extensive scientific publication record (less than 75 total publications and less than 25 publications as first or senior author), and has less than five years postgraduate career-track experience (not to exceed 12 years beyond completion of the terminal degree), and has not received competitively awarded Federal research funds as Project Director (PD) with the exception of pre- or postdoctoral grants, equipment grants, and AFRI Seed Grants is eligible to submit an application for a New Investigator Standard Grant for research, education, and/or extension activities. Federal funding received by the applicant as Co-PD of previously awarded competitive grants does not count against New Investigator eligibility.

Eligibility requirements for a New Investigator Grant apply only to the PD and not to Co-PDs or collaborators. The application must contain documentation that lists all prior federal support. The work proposed for New Investigator Grants must address a specific Program Area Priority described in Part I, C of the NOFO.

New Investigator Grant applications do not need to adhere to the eligibility requirements described for Strengthening Grants below unless they are applying under both grant types.

There are two types of New Investigator Grants available:

1) The first is a Standard Grant (i.e., New Investigator Standard Grant), which is a Standard Grant application in all respects except that the Project Director meets the eligibility criteria described previously for New Investigators. These are reviewed with all other Standard Grant applications submitted to the respective program area priority, with special consideration given by NIFA program staff to funding of New Investigator Standard Grant applications that fall below the funding line. In these cases, the New Investigator box must be checked under FASE on the AFRI Project Type form.

   Project Narrative page limit for New Investigator Standard Grant applications is 18 pages.

2) Individuals qualifying as New Investigators are also eligible to apply for a Seed Grant (i.e., New Investigator Seed Grants described subsequently) regardless of institutional affiliation and eligibility for Strengthening Grants described subsequently. An individual applicant may submit only one Seed Grant as PD during the current fiscal year. New Investigators also may only receive one New Investigator Seed Grant as PD during their career. New Investigator Seed Grant applications will be reviewed with other Seed Grant applications submitted to the respective program area priority with special consideration given to funding of New Investigator Seed Grant applications. In these cases, both the New Investigator and Seed Grant boxes should be checked under FASE on the AFRI Project Type form.

   Project Narrative page limit for New Investigator Seed Grant applications is 7 pages.

c. Strengthening Grants

These funds are expected to enhance institutional capacity with the goal of leading to future funding in the project area, as well as strengthen the competitiveness of the investigator's research, education, and/or extension activities. Strengthening Grants consist of Seed Grants, Equipment Grants, Sabbatical Grants, Strengthening Standard Grants, Strengthening Coordinated Agricultural Projects (CAP) Grants and

Strengthening Workshop Grants. The work proposed for Strengthening Grants must address specific Program Area Priorities described under Program Area Descriptions in Part I, C., of the NOFO. All applications submitted for Strengthening Grants must fulfill the eligibility requirements described below.

1) Strengthening Grants Eligibility

Strengthening grants are limited to 1) small and mid-sized or minority-serving degree-granting institutions that previously had limited institutional success for receiving Federal funds or 2) State Agricultural Experiment Stations or degree-granting institutions eligible for USDA Established Program to Stimulate Competitive Research (EPSCoR) funding. The grants submitted by these institutions are eligible for reserved strengthening funds for Research, Education, Extension, and Integrated Project grants. See the Flow Chart for Strengthening Grant Eligibility to assist with determining eligibility for Strengthening Grants. Eligibility requirements for Strengthening Grants apply only to the PD's institution and not to the institutions of Co-PDs or collaborators.

2) Request for Determination of Status

3) Minority Serving Institution

If an institution is applying for a Strengthening Grant and wants the Secretary to consider a group, beyond one included in the minority definition (see Strengthening Grants Eligibility Definitions), then documentation (see below) must be submitted as part of the full application package by the applicable program area or program area priority deadline. The Secretary of Agriculture (or designated individual) will use the information in the documentation to determine whether the group or groups identified are qualified as a minority group for the purpose of receiving a Strengthening Grant under the FASE program.

Documentation for the request for determination as a minority-serving institution must include the following and be provided in the order specified below:

a. A description of each minority group being submitted for determination;

b. Data or studies supporting this group's designation as a minority group; and

c. Data indicating that enrollment of the minority group(s) exceeds 50 percent of the total enrollment at the academic institution, including graduate and undergraduate and full-and part-time students.

4) Strengthening Grants Eligibility Definitions

a) EPSCoR States (see also FASE & EPSCoR Program)

Every year, the National Institute of Food and Agriculture (NIFA) determines the states that are eligible for USDA EPSCoR funding. This list includes states having a funding level no higher than the 38th percentile of all States based on a 3-year rolling average of AFRI funding levels, excluding FASE Strengthening funds granted to EPSCoR States and small-midsized and minority-serving degree-granting institutions.

2025:

For FY 2026 AFRI funding opportunities, including the AFRI Foundational and Applied Science Program, AFRI Education and Workforce Development Program, and AFRI Strengthening Agricultural Systems Program applications for 2025 deadlines, the eligibility determinations are based on the data obtained from grants made through AFRI from 2021 through 2023. For 2025, the following States meet the requirements for this category:

State Name	Abbreviation
Alaska	AK
Connecticut	CT
Delaware	DE
Hawaii	HI
Idaho	ID
Kentucky	KY
Maine	ME
Montana	MT
North Dakota	ND
New Jersey	NJ
New Mexico	NM
Nevada	NV
Rhode Island	RI
South Carolina	SC
South Dakota	SD
Utah	UT
Vermont	VT
West Virginia	WV
Wyoming	WY

Other geographies eligible for USDA EPSCoR funds for FY 2026 AFRI NOFOs include the following United States commonwealths, territories, possessions and their successors, and the District of Columbia:

Name	Abbreviation
American Samoa	AS
District of Columbia	DC

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Name	Abbreviation
Guam	GU
Micronesia	FM
Northern Marianas	MP
Puerto Rico	PR
Virgin Islands (U.S.)	VI

b) **Small and mid-sized institutions** are academic institutions with a current total enrollment of 17,500 or less, including graduate and undergraduate as well as full- and part-time students. An institution in this instance is an organization that possesses a significant degree of autonomy as defined by being independently accredited in the current version of the Higher Education Directory, published by Higher Education Publications, Inc., 1801 Robert Fulton Drive, Suite 340, Reston, Virginia 20191 (Phone: (888) 349-7715; www.hepinc.com).

c) **Minority-serving institutions** are academic institutions whose enrollment of a single minority group or a combination of minority groups exceeds 50 percent of the total enrollment, including graduate and undergraduate as well as full- and part-time students.

Minority means Alaskan Native, American Indian, Asian-American, African-American, Hispanic American, Native Hawaiian, or Pacific Islander. The Secretary will determine on a case-by-case basis whether additional groups qualify under this definition, either at the Secretary of Agriculture's initiative, or in response to a written request with supporting explanation.

Applicants applying under this category should indicate the current percentage of applicable minority students enrolled at the institution in a cover letter. An institution in this instance is an organization that possesses a significant degree of autonomy as defined by being independently accredited in the current version of the Higher Education Directory, published by Higher Education Publications, Inc., 1801 Robert Fulton Drive, Suite 340, Reston, Virginia 20191 (Phone: (888) 349-7715; www.hepinc.com.

d) **Limited institutional success** is defined as institutions that are not among the most successful universities and colleges for receiving Federal funds for science and engineering research and development. See the AFRI NOFO Resources page ("Table 1 Most Successful Institutions" in the attachments list) for an alphabetical list of the most successful institutions.

All institutions grouped under one main campus as listed in Table 1 Most Successful Institutions, unless located in an EPSCoR state, are excluded from eligibility for all strengthening funds. The institution may petition for an exemption to this rule as described in Part III, B of the NOFO.

5) Strengthening Grant Types

An individual applicant may submit only one of the following types of strengthening applications (Sabbatical Grant, Equipment Grant, or Seed Grant) as Project Director (PD) during the current review cycle. Investigators are encouraged to contact the appropriate Program Area Priority Contact, regarding suitability of project topics to verify that their submission is appropriate to the program area priority. For Equipment Grants, investigators are encouraged to contact the appropriate Program Area Priority Contact regarding appropriateness of requested equipment for topics within program area priority requirements.

a) Seed Grants

Seed Grants are to provide funds to enable institutions or investigators to collect preliminary data or perform other preliminary activities in preparation for applying for future grants from AFRI. The grants are not intended to fund stand-alone projects, but rather projects that will lead to further work applicable to one of the AFRI Program Area Priorities. Seed Grant applications submitting to an Integrated Program Area Priority only need to include one of the three functions (research, education, extension) and must justify how this Seed Grant will allow the applicant to become competitive for future Integrated Project funding. Seed grants are not renewable. **Seed grant Project Directors (PDs) may receive no more than two seed grants (for different projects) within any five-year period.**

New Investigators are also eligible to apply for a Seed Grant (i.e., New Investigator Seed Grant). Individuals applying for a New Investigator Seed Grant must meet the eligibility criteria for New Investigators described previously, but do not need to meet eligibility for Strengthening Grants. In this case, the New Investigator Seed box should be checked under FASE on the AFRI Project Type form. An individual New Investigator applicant **may submit only one Seed Grant as PD during the current review cycle**. New Investigators also may only receive **one New Investigator Seed Grant during their career**.

Seed Grants are limited to a total of $300,000 (including indirect costs) for up to 2-years in duration and are not renewable. All Seed Grant applications submitted to the respective program area priority will be reviewed together,

with separate funding considerations given to Strengthening Seed Grant and New Investigator Seed Grant applications.

Project Narrative page limit for Strengthening Seed Grant applications and New Investigator Seed Grant applications is 7 pages.

b) Equipment Grants

Equipment Grants are designed to strengthen the research, education, and/or extension capacity of institutions by funding the purchase of one major piece of equipment. These grants are not intended to replace requests for equipment in individual project applications. Rather, they are intended to help fund items of equipment that will upgrade infrastructure. Requests for computer equipment are allowed only if the equipment is to be used in an activity integral to the proposed project. Requests for computer equipment will not be permitted if the equipment will primarily serve as a word processor or perform administrative functions.

Each request shall be limited to one major piece of equipment within the cost range of $10,000-$250,000 and are not renewable. The amount of Federal funding requested shall not exceed 50 percent of the cost or $50,000, whichever is less. Unless a waiver is granted by NIFA using the criteria listed in Part III, C., of the NOFO, it is the responsibility of the PD to secure required matching funds with non-Federal funds (see Part III, C for more information). No installation, maintenance, warranty, or insurance expenses may be paid from these grants, nor may these costs be part of the matching funds. Indirect costs are not permitted on Equipment Grants.

Project Narrative page limit for Equipment Grant applications is 7 pages.

c) Sabbatical Grants

Sabbatical Grants are to provide an opportunity for faculty to enhance their research, education, and/or extension capabilities by funding sabbatical leaves. Collaborative arrangements, domestic or international, are encouraged. Grants will be limited to one year of salary and funds for travel and supplies, where justified, and are not renewable.

NIFA will also consider supporting “mini-sabbaticals” for faculty and researchers desiring short-term training to learn new techniques that will improve their competitiveness. These short-term training opportunities generally follow all the sabbatical requirements described beginning in Part IV, C., of the NOFO but for a shorter duration. These grants may be used to participate in short courses offered at various research institutions.

Project Narrative page limit for Sabbatical Grant applications is 7 pages.

d) Strengthening Standard Grants

Standard Grant applications that meet the eligibility requirements for Strengthening Grants are eligible for reserved strengthening funds as Strengthening Standard Grants. The eligibility requirements only apply to the institution of the lead PD and are not required for Co-PD(s) associated with the project.

Project Narrative page limit for Strengthening Standard Grant applications is 18 pages, see Standard Grants for exceptions.

e) Strengthening Coordinated Agricultural Project (CAP) Grants

Coordinated Agricultural Project (CAP) Grant applications that meet the eligibility requirements for Strengthening Grants are eligible for reserved strengthening funds as Strengthening CAP Grants. The eligibility requirements only apply to the institution of the lead PD and are not required for Co-PD(s) associated with the project.

Project Narrative page limit for Strengthening CAP Grant applications is 18 pages.

f) Strengthening Workshop Grants

Workshop Grant applications that meet the eligibility requirements for Strengthening Grants are eligible for reserved strengthening funds as Strengthening Workshop Grants. The eligibility requirements only apply to the institution of the lead PD and are not required for Co-PD(s) associated with the project.

Project Narrative page limit for Strengthening Workshop Grant applications is 18 pages.

PART II—AWARD INFORMATION

C. Project Types and Grant Types

1. Project Types

Applicants must propose one of the AFRI project types specified within the relevant program area descriptions in Part I, C of the NOFO. Only project types specifically solicited under each program area priority described in Part I, C of the NOFO will be considered for review. Project Type(s) invited by each program area or program area priority may differ by grant type. See the "AFRI Grant Types" PDF in the attachments list on the AFRI NOFO Resources page for more information.

There are four project types available across the Agriculture and Food Research Initiative (AFRI) portfolio. These are 1) Research, 2) Education, 3) Extension and 4) Integrated Research, Education, and/or Extension Projects. Each of these project types is described below:

1) **Research Projects**
   Single-function Research Projects support fundamental or applied research conducted by individual investigators, co-investigators within the same discipline, or multidisciplinary teams.

   Fundamental research means research that (i) increases knowledge or understanding of the fundamental aspects of phenomena and has the potential for broad application and (ii) has an effect on agriculture, food, nutrition or the environment.

   Applied research means research that includes expansion of the findings of fundamental research to uncover practical ways in which new knowledge can be advanced to benefit individuals and society.

   Multi-disciplinary projects are those in which investigators from two or more disciplines collaborate closely to address a common problem. These collaborations, where appropriate, may integrate the biological, physical, chemical, and/or social sciences.

2) **Education Projects**
   Single-function Education Projects develop human capital relevant to overall portfolio goals for U.S. agriculture. An education activity or teaching activity is formal classroom instruction, laboratory instruction, or practicum experience in the food and agricultural sciences and other related matters such as faculty development, student recruitment and services, curriculum development, instructional materials and equipment, and innovative teaching methodologies.

   Applications for Education Projects may include any of the following activities: conducting classroom and laboratory instruction or providing practicum experience; faculty research

internships for curricula development; cutting-edge agricultural science and technology curriculum development; innovative teaching methodologies; instructional materials development; education delivery systems; student experiential learning (student led-research; internships; externships; clinics); student learning styles and student-centered instruction; student recruitment and retention efforts; career planning materials and counseling; pedagogy; faculty development programs; development of modules for on-the-job training; providing knowledge and skills for professionals creating policy or transferring to the agriculture workforce; faculty and student exchanges; and international research opportunities relevant to overall goals for U.S. agriculture. The activities for Education Projects must show direct alignment with increasing technical competency in one or more AFRI program area priorities to ensure that the U.S. remains globally competitive in the knowledge age.

Applicants interested in student study abroad activities are encouraged to contact the Program Contact listed in the NOFO to discuss the anticipated project parameters and outcomes to ensure the application content appropriately meets the requirements of an Education Project.

Education Projects must address one or two of the following key strategic actions:

a) Train students for Associate, Baccalaureate, Master's or Doctoral degrees; and/or

b) Prepare K-12 teachers and higher education faculty to understand and present food and agricultural sciences.

These projects should lead to measurable, documented changes in learning, actions, or conditions in an identified audience or stakeholder group. These projects should synthesize and incorporate a wide range of the latest relevant research results.

3) Extension Projects

Single-function Extension Projects conduct programs and activities that deliver science-based knowledge and informal educational programs to people, enabling them to make practical decisions. Delivery may range from community-based to national audiences and use communication methods from face-to-face to electronic or combinations thereof. Extension Projects may also include related matters such as certification programs, in-service training, client recruitment and services, curriculum development, instructional materials and equipment, and innovative instructional methodologies appropriate to informal educational programs.

Extension Projects address one or more of the following key strategic actions:

a) Support informal education to increase food and agricultural literacy of youth and adults;
b) Promote science-based agricultural literacy by increasing understanding and use of food and agricultural science data, information, and programs;
c) Build science-based capability in people to engage audiences and enable informed decision making;
d) Develop new applications of instructional tools and curriculum structures that increase technical competency and ensure global competitiveness;

e) Offer non-formal learning programs that increases access of new audiences at the rate at which new ideas and technologies are tested and/or developed at the community-scale; and
f) Develop programs that increase public knowledge and citizen engagement leading to actions that protect or enhance the nations' food supply, agricultural productivity, environmental quality, community vitality, and/or public health and well-being.

These projects should lead to measurable, documented changes in learning, actions, or conditions in an identified audience or stakeholder group. These projects should synthesize and incorporate a wide range of the latest relevant research results.

4) Integrated Research, Education, and/or Extension Projects

An Integrated Project includes at least **two** of the three functions of the agricultural knowledge system (*i.e.*, research, education, and extension) within a project, although some program area priorities may require that Integrated Project applications include all three components of the agricultural knowledge system. Applicants should consult the Program Area Priority Description beginning in Part I. C of the NOFO for the specific requirements of the program area priority to which they are applying.

The functions addressed in the project should be focused around a problem or issue and should be interwoven throughout the life of the project to complement and reinforce one another. The functions should be interdependent and necessary for the success of the project and <u>no more than two-thirds of the project's budget</u> <u>may be focused on a single component</u>.

a) The proposed **Research** component of an integrated project should address knowledge gaps that are critical to the development of practices and programs to address the stated problem.

b) The proposed **Education** (teaching and teaching-related) component of an Integrated Project should develop human capital relevant to for U.S. agriculture in one or more AFRI program area priority(ies). An education or teaching activity is formal classroom instruction, laboratory instruction, or practicum experience in the food and agricultural sciences and other related matters such as faculty development, student recruitment and services, curriculum development, instructional materials and equipment, and innovative teaching methodologies, as described in part II.C.1.b. above.
Educational activities may include any of the following: conducting classroom and laboratory instruction and practicum experience; faculty research internships for curricula development; cutting-edge agricultural science and technology curriculum development; innovative teaching methodologies; instructional materials development; education delivery systems; student experiential learning (student led-research; internships; externships; clinics); student learning styles and student-centered instruction; student recruitment and retention efforts; career planning materials and counseling; pedagogy; faculty development programs; development of modules for on-the-job training;

providing knowledge and skills for professionals creating policy or transferring to the agriculture workforce; faculty and student exchanges; and international research opportunities relevant to overall program goals for U.S. agriculture. Educational activities must show direct alignment with increasing technical competency in AFRI priority area(s) to ensure that U.S. agriculture remains globally competitive in the knowledge age.

Applicants interested in student study abroad activities are encouraged to contact the Program Contact listed in the NOFO to discuss the anticipated project parameters and outcomes to ensure the application content appropriately meets the requirements of an Interested Project.

Educational components must address one or two of the following key strategic actions:

i. Train students for Associate, Baccalaureate, Master's or Doctoral degrees; and/or
ii. Prepare K-12 teachers and higher education faculty to understand and present food and agricultural sciences.

Integrated projects that include an educational component should synthesize and incorporate a wide range of the latest relevant research results. **Note that routine use of undergraduate students, graduate students and postdoctoral personnel to conduct research is not considered education for the purposes of the AFRI portfolio**.

3) The proposed **Extension** component of an Integrated Project should conduct activities that deliver science-based knowledge and informal educational programs to people, enabling them to make practical decisions. Delivery may range from community-based to national audiences and use communication methods from face-to-face to electronic or combinations thereof. Extension Projects may also include related matters such as certification programs, in-service training, client recruitment and services, curriculum development, instructional materials and equipment, and innovative instructional methodologies appropriate to informal educational programs, as described in part II.C.1.c. previously.

   Extension activities may address, but are not limited to, the following key strategic actions:

   a) Support informal education to increase food, agricultural, and health literacy of youth and adults;
   b) Promote science-based agricultural literacy by increasing understanding and use of food and agricultural science data, information, and programs;
   c) Build science-based capability in people to engage audiences and enable informed decision making;
   d) Develop new applications of instructional tools and curriculum structures that increase technical competency and ensure global competitiveness;

e) Offer non-formal learning programs that increases access of new audiences at the rate at which new ideas and technologies are tested and/or developed at the community-scale; and
f) Develop programs that increase public knowledge and citizen engagement leading to actions that protect or enhance the nation's food supply, agricultural productivity, environmental quality, community vitality, food security and/or public health and well-being.

Integrated projects that include an Extension component should synthesize and incorporate a wide range of the latest relevant research results. **Note that research-related activities such as publication of papers or speaking at scientific meetings are not considered extension for the purposes of the AFRI portfolio.**

Integrated Projects aim to resolve today's problems through the application of science-based knowledge and address needs identified by stakeholders. Integrated Projects clearly identify anticipated outcomes and have a plan for evaluating and documenting the success of the project. These projects should lead to measurable, documented changes in learning, actions, or conditions in an identified audience or stakeholder group.

Those interested in submitting Integrated Project applications are encouraged to contact the Program Contact listed in the NOFO to discuss the anticipated project parameters and outcomes to ensure the application content appropriately meets the requirements of an Integrated Project.